PATIENT INFORMATION

Your plan to quit smoking

Quitting is the best thing you can do for your health, and you don't have to rely on willpower alone. **Medicine plus support roughly doubles your chances of success.**

What happens when you stop

20 minutes	Heart rate and blood pressure start to fall
12 hours	Carbon monoxide in your blood returns to normal
2–12 weeks	Circulation and breathing improve
1–9 months	Less cough and breathlessness
1 year	Heart-attack risk falls to about half
10 years	Lung-cancer risk about half that of a smoker
15 years	Heart-disease risk like a non-smoker

The first weeks: normal and temporary

You may feel irritable or restless, find it hard to concentrate, sleep badly, feel low or anxious, or be hungrier than usual. These are signs your body is adjusting. They are strongest in the first week and usually ease within 2–4 weeks.

Know your triggers

Feelings	Stress, sadness, boredom, even joy	Breathe 4-5-6: in for 4 seconds, hold 5, out slowly over 6 · walk for a few minutes · write the feeling down · sip water · call a supportive friend
Routine	With coffee, driving, after meals, before sleep	Get up straight after eating · sugar-free gum or miswak · keep your hands busy · Qur'an or a podcast while driving
People	Friends who smoke, gatherings, shisha nights	Say "no, thank you" clearly · change where you sit · sit with people who support you
Places	Smells, lighters, your usual smoking spot	Remove all cigarettes and lighters · air and freshen rooms · choose smoke-free places

Get help; it works

- Ask your family doctor about **medicine to stop smoking**: it makes cravings much easier.
- Book a **smoking-cessation clinic** on the **Sehhaty** app: Appointments → Book a new appointment → in-person or virtual → Smoking-cessation clinic.
- E-cigarettes, shisha and medwakh are still nicotine addiction. The goal is to be free of all of them.

My quit plan

My quit date:

My support partner:

My reasons to quit:

What I will do instead when a craving comes:

My follow-up appointment:

Trigger diary; for 3 to 5 days before your quit date

Day	Time	Place	Mood	Who was with me

A slip is not the end

If you smoke again, don’t give up. Remember why you decided to quit, notice what triggered it, and start again from where you stopped. Tell your doctor: every attempt brings you closer.

Family Medicine Guides · Based on WHO and USPSTF guidance and the national patient guide “Your Journey to Quit Smoking” (Public Health Authority and partners). This leaflet does not replace advice from your doctor. Prepared and medically supervised by Dr. Albaraa Albawab, Family Medicine. Written with AI assistance, checked by the medical editor, and still under review with colleagues.